

Evidence Tracker — C-File Organizer Template

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Why a tracker matters

Your VA Claims File (C-file) often has hundreds — sometimes thousands — of pages. When you file an HLR or Supplemental and need to point to specific evidence, you need to find it fast. This tracker is your map.

How to use this tracker

1. **Request your full C-file** — submit a Privacy Act request via VA.gov (allow 30–90 days)
 2. **Open it as a single PDF** — number every page
 3. **For each entry below, fill in the page numbers and any quotes**
 4. When filing HLR/Supplemental, cite by page number: *"See C-file pp. 47, 51, 89"*
-

Master log

#	Document	Type	Date	C-file pp.	Notes / Key Quote
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					

#	Document	Type	Date	C-file pp.	Notes / Key Quote
8					
9					
10					

(This file converts to a Word doc when you open it. Add more rows as needed, or use the spreadsheet version.)

Document type cheat sheet

Type	Examples
Service treatment record (STR)	In-service medical records, sick calls, line-of-duty determinations
Service personnel record	DD-214, DA-31, awards, evaluations
VA medical record	VA primary care, mental health, specialty notes
Private medical record	Outside provider notes, hospital records, ER visits
C&P exam	Compensation & Pension exam reports
DBQ	Disability Benefits Questionnaires (private or VA)
Lay statement	Buddy letters, spouse statements, personal statements
Imaging / labs	MRI, X-ray, blood work
Federal record	Military, SSA, DOJ records
Decision letter	Rating decisions, denials, awards
ITF receipt	Intent to File confirmations
Form	Filed VA forms (21-526EZ, 20-0995, 20-0996, etc.)

Per-condition evidence map

For each condition you're claiming, build a focused mini-table linking evidence to rating criteria.

Condition: _____

Diagnostic Code: _____ · **Currently rated:** _____% · **Seeking:** _____%

Rating criteria element	Evidence (C-file pp.)	Strength
Symptom: _____		
Frequency: _____		
Severity: _____		
Functional impact: _____		
Continuity of symptoms: ____		

Strength legend: ✓✓ direct medical finding · ✓ supportive · ? ambiguous · ✗ contradicts

"Strongest 5" quick list

When prepping for an HLR conference or writing a Supplemental cover statement, distill your evidence to the top 5 strongest items:

Rank	Evidence	C-file pp.	Why it matters
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

TIP: If you can't articulate "why it matters" in one sentence, it's probably not your strongest evidence.

Missing evidence checklist

Things often missing from a C-file that may help your claim:

- ☐ Pre-service medical records (if condition existed before service or was noted at entrance exam)
 - ☐ Service treatment records from deployment / TDY units (often filed separately)
 - ☐ VA records from facilities other than your primary
 - ☐ Private treatment records (require Form 21-4142 to authorize)
 - ☐ Buddy statements from people who served with you
 - ☐ Spouse/family statements about post-service symptom onset
 - ☐ Vocational rehabilitation (Chapter 31) file
 - ☐ DOL records if you've filed for SSA disability
 - ☐ Workers comp records relating to a claimed condition
 - ☐ Unit history / morning reports for stressor verification (PTSD claims)
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Personal statement evidence index

If you've submitted a personal statement, log it here:

Topic	Date submitted	Page count	Key claim

Pull list — records you need to request

Use this to track outstanding record requests:

Source	Type	Date requested	Method	Status	Date received

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